majority in a public survey indicated that they, too, worried about the Soviet drive to win over uncommitted nations.[3]

Furthermore, in the Cold War, the battles for territory were giving way to battles for not just hearts and minds but also stomachs. The Eisenhower administration believed that if the free world could not prove that democracy and development could coexist, it would lose large sections of the world. By the mid-1950s, it had also become apparent that the US was not the best model to demonstrate democracy's ability to deliver. For countries just emerging from colonialism, far behind on the socioeconomic and political development ladder, a country like India would be more relatable.

Conceptually, officials and observers were increasingly juxtaposing the democratic Indian development experiment against the communist Chinese one. Given the "keen competition" with China, Secretary of State John Foster Dulles stressed in public remarks in December 1956 that "[a] great deal depends" on India's success.[4] Consequently, many officials argued, the US had a stake in facilitating an Indian victory.

There was a related challenge—that of potential Indian failure. Rather than outright attacks or invasions, there was a sense that internal subversion in underdeveloped or developing countries was a more imminent threat. Communism might win in these countries not through the use of military instruments, but through the exploitation of economic weakness. If individuals in noncommunist countries felt that their system of government would not deliver, they would look to another way of life and thus be more susceptible to communism. Thus the free world could lose India if Indians looked at neighboring China moving ahead under communism.

With the change in diagnosis of threat came a change in prescription—to one that matched that of India. The US could strengthen free world security and these nonaligned countries, especially India, by focusing on development. It could help not by giving them military assistance, which a number of them did not want anyway, but by providing economic assistance.

Given the China-India competition, US ambassador to India and former senator John Sherman Cooper called for a re-evaluation of American aid policy toward India. Following up on a commitment to the White House, he sent an assessment arguing that India could demonstrate "the superior